The desk: stopped tools

Above: DESK.md §4 (stopped tools) and §3 (the tool context).

Talks to:

- the web layer, which serves a stopped tool on its own address;
- home, which stops, deletes and restores tools;
- the stopped tool's own file, read-only;
- qp and the journal, which read a stopped tool's history through the shared record.

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1. What it is

A stopped tool's history, still readable. Stopping a tool ends its scanning, but **everything it ever recorded stays open** on its own address: its registers, its photos, its outcomes, its scorecard. A deleted tool is the same — off every list, but nothing erased.

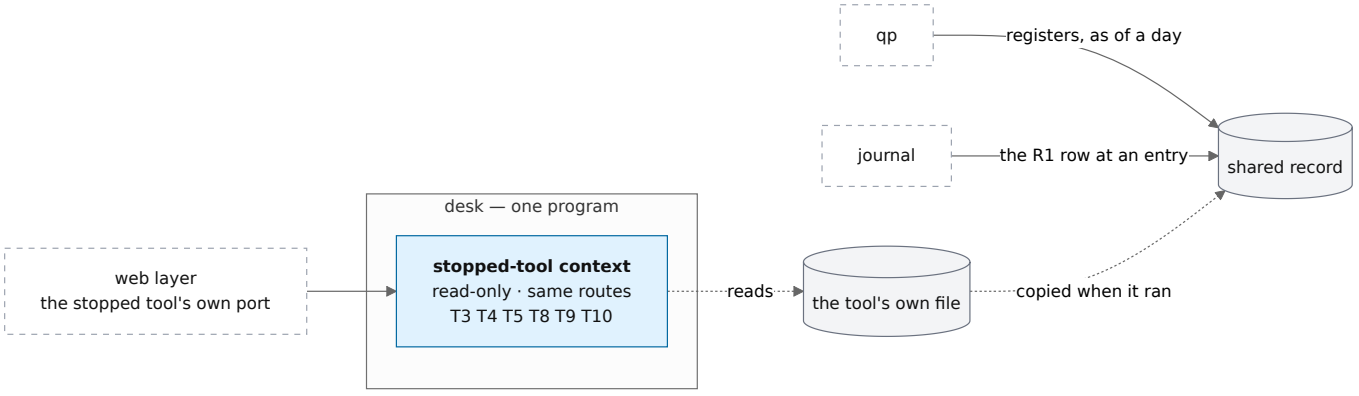
In the design a stopped tool is **a read-only context inside the desk** (DESK.md §3), opened over its file read-only, serving the same routes on the same port it used when it ran. It replaces the old desk's separate **archive** program, which loaded a copy of the modules for each stopped tool.

What it owns: nothing new — it only reads a tool's stored file.

What it never does: scan, re-quote, score, or write anything. It has no scanner, scheduler or write route.

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2. The diagram



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3. Its parts

3.1 A read-only context

When the desk starts, each stopped tool's file is opened **read-only** (DESK.md §4.1). The context answers the same page and warehouse routes the running tool did, on the same port — so a

saved chart, a bookmark and qp's register reads over the old URL all keep working. It registers no jobs and holds no live list.

3.2 Fully readable, scorecard included

A stopped tool stays **completely** readable — its registers, its photos and its scorecard. The old archive answered only the warehouse routes, so a stopped tool's scorecard, and the benchmark tool's, vanished from the comparison (D-S14). Reading a stopped tool as a desk context fixes that: the comparison can still judge against a stopped benchmark (HOME.md §3.2).

3.3 Started, stopped, restored

Home moves a tool between running and stopped (HOME.md §3.3): stopping closes the running context and opens the read-only one; starting closes the read-only context (releasing the port) and opens the running one; restoring a deleted tool takes the deleted mark off and brings it back stopped. An id is never reused, so a stopped or deleted tool's history is never confused with a new tool's.

3.4 Where qp and the journal read it

qp and the journal never open a tool's file — they read its photos and outcomes from the **shared record**, which holds a copy of every tool's registers written while it ran (SHARED-RECORD.md). So a backtest or a trade snapshot over a stopped tool's history needs no running tool at all; the read-only context is for the tool's own pages.

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4. Contracts

It reads	From
a stopped tool's registers, photos, outcomes, scorecard	that tool's own file, opened read-only

It serves	Where
the tool's page and warehouse routes, read-only	the tool's own port (WEB.md, tool/PAGES.md)

It writes nothing. The copies qp and the journal read are in the shared record, written by the tool while it ran (SHARED-RECORD.md).

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5. When it fails

Event	What happens
the desk restarts	each stopped tool's file is reopened read-only; its pages come back on its port
a stopped tool's file is missing	its context reports the file is unreadable, rather than serving empty pages silently
a tool is started	its read-only context is closed first, so it releases the port before the running context takes it

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6. Built on

The old desk: the **archive** program (legacy/screeners/TOOL-LIFECYCLE.md, "The archive"), one read-only process that opened each stopped tool's database and answered `/api/warehouse/*` on its port.

What failed there:

ID	Fault	Prevented by
D-S14	the archive answered only the warehouse routes, so a stopped tool's scorecard (and the benchmark's) disappeared from the comparison	a stopped tool is a full read-only context, scorecard included
—	the archive loaded a separate copy of the modules for each stopped tool ("require-cache surgery")	one program, one read-only context per stopped tool

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7. Status

Part	Status
stopped tools served by the old archive program	**built** (legacy)
stopped tools served by the desk as read-only contexts	**to build** (migration step A): the desk's first job, in place of the archive